13.4 YOKES

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- **To understand the different types of yoke.**
- **To enable the students to select yoke suitable for various garments.**

13.4.1 Introduction

Yoke is one segment of the garment that can be constructed on the garment. It can be seen in the garment of children, men and women. It is introduced in a garment based on the need and to hold the gathers. For decorative purpose, it is sewn at shoulder, upper and lower part of the hip. Yokes can be constructed with different structures, variations like 'V' shape, oval shape or with different colour according to the taste and need of person.

13.4.2 Types of Yokes

Yokes are classified based upon the pattern made and decorations as plain or basic yoke and decorative yoke.

13.4.2.1 Plain / Basic Yoke

Plain or basic yoke has got simple structure. It can be placed on front and back part of men's shirt. According to the shape of garment, use of garment, age of person, yokes are suitably cut and joined. This yoke is a part of the garment which is cut and joined with a piping or seam. **Example :** Bodice block of a body front cut half way through to add with gathers to the rest of the garment.

For drafting yokes take a bodice pattern and mark from the shoulder to the center of the front bodice. This technique can be used to construct 'V' shaped and circular shaped yoke. To construct a straight yoke, marking should be made according to the length of yoke from arm scye to center front,(Figure 13.26).

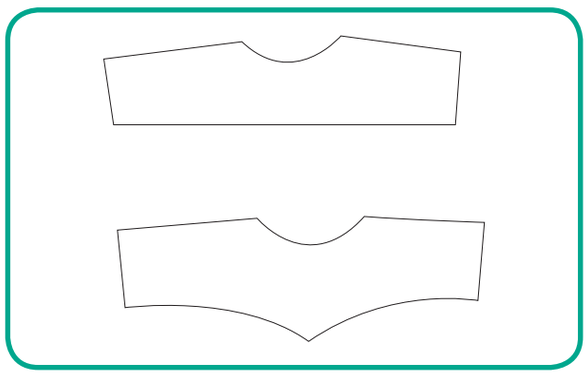


Figure 13.26 Basic Yoke

13.4.2.2 Decorative Yoke

Contrast colour materials can be used for making yoke. Use of various tucks, pleats and frills add interest to the garment. According to the wish of wearer, piping or frills can be stitched at the edges of the yoke.

Yoke can be joined using plain fabric or by adding one or more layers for stiffness. For skirts, yoke is cut to the shape of the waist line. Then the skirt part is gathered and attached to the yoke. The bottom of the yoke should match to the size of the gathering in the skirt.

To construct yokes with curved edges on panel skirt, lapped seam can be used. These kinds of yoke can be used on the bodice part of kid's front, upper part of night dresses and on the waist bands of skirts. Yokes of desired shape can be cut and stitched and decorations using embroideries can be added to the garment. (Figure 13.27).

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